



Rifle cartridges

A cartridge consisted of a minié ball and its powder charge wrapped in paper. The soldier bit open the cartridge before loading, a process that left his face blackened by powder. In some new models of rifle, paper cartridges were superseded by metal cartridges during the Civil War.



Standard issue rifle musket

The 1861 Springfield percussion rifle musket was the standard infantry weapon throughout the war. It had a 40-in (101.6-cm) barrel, weighed 9lb (4kg), and its range and accuracy made it popular with the troops.

The line breaks down

Both Northern and Southern generals had no doubt that battles could only be won by large bodies of drilled and disciplined troops automatically obeying orders. Popular manuals, such as W. J. Hardee's *Rifle and Light Infantry Tactics*, stated that infantry should attack by advancing steadily in close packed lines, kept in strict formation by their officers, with men acting as "file closers" at the rear to stop the cowardly from skulking away. When close enough